

CLA Brand & Design Language OS v1

Section 5 - Photography

STATUS: APPROVED

Primary Photography Style

- Authentic real moments.
- Real worship.
- Real prayer.
- Real people.
- Never staged.
- Never stock-photo looking.

Photography Tone

- Bright and vibrant for joy, children, families, community, and events.
- Natural and realistic for everyday church life.
- Dark and dramatic for worship, prayer, Scripture, and reflective moments.
- The tone must match the story being told.

Photography Layout

- Balanced use of full-width immersive photography and contained photography.
- The layout must support the story rather than follow one rigid rule.

People in Photography

- Balanced use of close emotional portraits and wide environmental storytelling.
- Balanced representation of pastors, members, families, children, volunteers, worship, prayer, and community.

Image Orientation

- Use a balanced mix of landscape and portrait photography.
- Display each image in its natural orientation whenever possible.
- Never force portrait images into landscape crops.
- Never force landscape images into portrait crops.
- Cropping must preserve faces, hands, subjects, and composition.

Editing Style

- Balanced mix of natural and cinematic editing.
- Editing must support the story and keep colors believable.

- Never over-edit.

Images Per Section

- Default to one strong image per section.
- Additional images are used only when they clearly improve the story.
- Quality is more important than quantity.

Decorative Effects

- Minimal only.
- Overlays, glows, frames, and filters may improve readability but must never become the focus.
- Authenticity comes before decoration.

Editorial Overlap

- Allowed occasionally when it clearly improves the composition.
- Never used only for decoration.

Consistency

- One recognizable CLA photography style across the website.
- Pages may adapt tone slightly when the story requires it, but must still feel like CLA.

Hero Photography

- Every major page begins with a signature hero photograph.
- Hero photography should immediately communicate the page purpose.
- Hero images must be professionally composed and optimized for desktop and mobile.
- Decorative graphics should not replace hero photography.